

Agricultural Policy and Economics

Science

May, 2026

Agricultural Policy and Economics (A07581)

Short Title: Agri. Policy and Economics
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author JGERAGHTY
Credits 5

Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

The purpose of this module is to study and evaluate the wider economic and policy environment which influences the agricultural industry. A wide range of topics are studied which directly or indirectly have a bearing on policy development, the economic prospects of the sector, and influence the contribution of agriculture to wider social and environmental objectives.

Programmes

AGRI-0104 BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Agriculture) (WD_SBSAG_B)

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Indicative Content

- History of Irish agricultural trade and agriculture's current contribution to the national economy
- Principles of agricultural policy: Principles of microeconomics; Rationale for support for agriculture; Alternative support measures; Agriculture as provider of public goods; Economic, social and environmental implications
- European Union and the Common Agricultural Policy: Enlargement; Objectives and Reform of the CAP; EU Budget and Ireland's contribution; non-market CAP policies and policies impacting on agriculture
- Comparative agricultural support systems: EU (CAP) v USA v Asia/Pacific v South America
- Principles of macroeconomics and international economic developments
- International trade in agricultural products: Current and emerging trade patterns; WTO rules and commitments; Trade conflicts
- Long term trends analysis: Population; incomes; lifestyle/market preferences; environmental protection; energy conservation; global warming
- Agricultural data sourcing and analysis: Compendium of Agricultural Statistics (Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine); National Farm Survey - current and recent trends (Teagasc); Annual Review and Outlook in Agriculture, Food and the Marine (DAFM); Aggregate output, input and incomes - current and recent years (CSO); International data (OECD)

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Evaluate the contribution of agriculture to national economic, social and environmental objectives.
2. Appraise current developments in the national and international economic environment.
3. Assess key features of agriculture support policy regimes.
4. Assess the implications for agriculture of likely trends emanating from the sector itself or from outside the sector.
5. Collect and analyse data relevant to general performance and the agricultural sector in particular.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Case studies.
- Visiting speakers and attendance at conferences or outside developments (where applicable).
- Video and webcast presentations.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	70%	1,2,3
Continuous Assessment	30%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	15%	5
<i>Assignment</i>	15%	4

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a good knowledge of the key learning outcomes including the contribution that agriculture makes to the Irish economy. The student will be able to source relevant data and present it in both assignment and exam.

50%-59%: Demonstrate a good understanding of agriculture in the wider EU and world context. The student will be able to source relevant data and present it in a clear manner in both assignment and exam.

60%-69%: Demonstrate a detailed knowledge of all the topics including the impact of European and world trade on Irish agriculture. The student will be able to source key data and present it in a clear manner in both assignment and exam.

70%-100%: Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, including the current and future trends in Irish, EU and competitor trading blocks. The student will be able to source key data and present it in a convincing manner in both assignment and exam.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Colman, D. *The Economics of the European Union*. 3rd ed. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2001.
- Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine. *Annual Review & Outlook in Agriculture, Food and the Marine*. Dublin. Annual.
- Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine. *Compendium of Irish Agricultural Statistics*. Dublin. 2013.
- Hennessy, T. and B. Moran. *National Farm Survey*. Dublin: Teagasc, Annual Publication.
- O'Hagan, J. and C. Newman. *The Economy of Ireland*. 12th ed. Dublin: Gill & Macmillan, 2014.

Supplementary Material

- "Agricultural Output Data." www.oecd.org. 31/08/2015. <https://data.oecd.org/agriculture.htm>
- McAleese, D. _Economics for Business_. 3rd ed. England: Prentice Hall Financial Times, 2004.